

Absolutely — **competition** is a strong polysemy target because your passage uses it here:

> “...small businesses always face challenges such as rising rent and strong **competition** ...”

Here **competition** means **rivalry between businesses trying to attract the same customers and succeed in the same market**. But the word also has major meanings involving **contests, competitive pressure, rivals collectively, ecology, and related forms such as compete / competitor / competitive / competitively**.

Word family: **compete / competition / competitor / competitive / competitively**

Base verb: compete

Noun: competition

Person/organisation noun: competitor

Adjective: competitive

Adverb: competitively

Part of speech: noun (名詞) / verb-family forms (動詞詞族)

Meaning in your passage: **competition = business rivalry — 商業競爭 ; 市場競爭**

Your phrase:

> “...rising rent and strong **competition** ...”

Here **competition** means:

> **the situation in which different businesses try to win the same customers, sales, market share, or advantage.**

繁體中文 :

不同企業為爭取相同客戶、銷售、市佔率或優勢而彼此競爭的情況 ; 商業競爭 / 市場競爭

Natural translation:

> “strong competition”

「**激烈的競爭**」

So here:

> **competition = 同行之間爭奪客戶和市場的競爭**

1. **competition = rivalry between people/businesses — 競爭；競爭關係**

The core broad meaning.

Practice 1 — Original

> “Small businesses face strong **competition**.”

「小企業要面對激烈的**競爭**。」

Practice 2

> “There is intense competition between local cafés.”

「本地咖啡店之間有激烈的**競爭**。」

Practice 3

> “Competition can encourage businesses to improve.”

「**競爭**可以促使企業進步。」

competition = 兩個或以上個人 / 機構為取得同一目標、資源或優勢而互相較量

2. **competition = market/business rivalry — 市場競爭；商業競爭**

This is your exact source sense.

Practice 4

> “The bakery faces **competition** from large chains.”

「這間麵包店要面對大型連鎖店的**競爭**。」

Practice 5

> “Strong competition has pushed prices down.”

「激烈的**市場競爭**令價格下降。」

competition — business = 同行企業爭取顧客、市佔率、收入或品牌優勢的狀態

3. **competition = organised contest — 比賽；競賽**

A major distinct meaning.

Practice 6

> “She entered a baking **competition**.”

「她參加了一個烘焙**比賽**。」

Practice 7

> “The photography competition attracted hundreds of entries.”

「這個攝影**比賽**吸引了數百份參賽作品。」

competition = 有正式規則、參賽者和結果的比賽 / 競賽

This is very different from ongoing market rivalry.

4. **competition = the act/process of competing — 競逐；較量**

A broader process sense.

Practice 8

> “The teams are in direct **competition**.”

「各隊正直接**競逐 / 較量**。」

Practice 9

> “The award created healthy competition among the students.”

「這個獎項在學生之間形成了良性的**競爭**。」

competition = 為取得同一目標而持續比較、較量的過程

5. **the competition = rivals / competing businesses or people — 競爭對手；同行**

A very important count/mass shift.

Practice 10

> “The bakery is doing better than **the competition**.”

「這間麵包店表現比**競爭對手 / 同行**更好。」

Practice 11

> “We need to understand what the competition is offering.”

「我們需要了解**競爭對手**正在提供甚麼。」

the competition = 與自己爭奪同一客戶、獎項或目標的其他人 / 企業

Excellent MCQ material.

6. **competition** = pressure created by rivals — **競爭壓力**

A common business/economic extension.

Practice 12

> “Competition is forcing shops to improve service.”

「**競爭壓力**正迫使商店改善服務。」

Practice 13

> “The company struggled under growing competition.”

「公司在愈來愈大的**競爭壓力**下苦苦支撐。」

competition = 因競爭者存在而對某人 / 企業造成的壓力

7. **competition** = rivalry for limited resources in ecology — **生態競爭**

A major scientific meaning.

Practice 14

> “Plants face **competition** for light and water.”

「植物會為陽光和水分產生**競爭**。」

Practice 15

> “Competition between species can affect population size.”

「物種之間的**競爭**可以影響族群數量。」

****competition — ecology = 生物因有限的食物、空間、光、水等資源而互相爭奪****

This is a genuinely distinct scientific domain.

8. ****compete = try to win / outperform others — 競爭；參賽****

The base verb.

Practice 16

> “Small bakeries must ****compete**** with large chains.”

「小型麵包店必須和大型連鎖店****競爭****。」

Practice 17

> “She competed in the cooking contest.”

「她參加了烹飪比賽。」

****compete = 為了勝出、取得資源或優勢而與他人較量****

9. ****compete with/against + rival = 與.....競爭****

Practice 18

> “The shop competes with several cafés nearby.”

「這間店和附近幾間咖啡店****競爭****。」

Practice 19

> “He competed against experienced runners.”

「他和經驗豐富的跑手**較量**。」

****compete with/against = 與某個明確對手競爭****

Both are common:

* compete with

* compete against

10. ****compete for + goal/resource = 爭奪；爭取****

Practice 20

> “Local shops compete for customers.”

「本地商店為顧客而**競爭**。」

Practice 21

> “Several candidates are competing for the position.”

「幾位候選人正在**競逐**這個職位。」

****compete for = 為取得同一目標、資源、職位或獎項而競爭****

11. ****compete in + event/field = 參加.....比賽；在.....領域競爭****

Practice 22

> “She competes in baking competitions.”

「她參加烘焙**比賽**。」

Practice 23

> “The company competes in the premium food market.”

「這家公司在高端食品市場中**競爭**。」

****compete in = 在某場比賽、某項運動或某個市場 / 領域參與競爭****

12. **competitor = person/team/business competing — 競爭者；競爭對手**

A major family noun.

Practice 24

> “A new **competitor** opened nearby.”

「附近新開了一家**競爭對手**。」

Practice 25

> “She defeated several strong competitors.”

「她擊敗了幾位強勁的**競爭者**。」

competitor = 與自己爭奪同一市場、獎項、名次或目標的人 / 團體 / 企業

13. **competitive = involving strong competition — 競爭激烈的**

Practice 26

> “The bakery market is highly **competitive**.”

「麵包店市場**競爭非常激烈**。」

Practice 27

> “It is a competitive industry.”

「這是一個**競爭激烈的行業**。」

competitive = 有很多人 / 企業互相爭取優勢、名次或資源的

14. **competitive = wanting strongly to win — 好勝的；競爭心強的**

A major person-trait meaning.

Practice 28

> “She is extremely **competitive**.”

「她非常**好勝 / 競爭心很強**。」

Practice 29

> “He becomes competitive during games.”

「他玩遊戲時會變得很**好勝**。」

competitive — person = 很想勝過別人、贏得比賽或取得較好結果的

15. **competitive = able to compete successfully — 有競爭力的**

A major business/economic meaning.

Practice 30

> “The bakery needs to remain **competitive**.”

「這間麵包店需要保持**競爭力**。」

Practice 31

> “Good service helps small businesses stay competitive.”

「良好服務有助小企業保持**競爭力**。」

competitive = 在市場 / 競爭中具備足夠優勢，可以與其他對手抗衡的

This differs from “競爭激烈的”.

16. **competitive price = 有競爭力的價格；具吸引力的價格**

A very common commercial compound.

Practice 32

> “The shop offers **competitive prices**.”

「這間店提供**有競爭力的價格**。」

Practice 33

> “They need to keep prices competitive.”

「他們需要維持價格的**市場競爭力**。」

competitive price = 與市場其他選擇相比具有吸引力、足以競爭的價格

It does not necessarily mean “the cheapest”.

17. **competitively priced = 價格具競爭力的**

Practice 34

> “The products are **competitively priced**.”

「這些產品的**定價具競爭力**。」

Practice 35

> “The café is competitively priced for the area.”

「以這區來說，這間咖啡店的**價格很有競爭力**。」

competitively priced = 價格設定得足以和市場其他選項競爭

18. **competitively = in a way that can compete well — 具競爭力地**

Practice 36

> “The company must price its products **competitively**.”

「公司必須以**具競爭力的方式**定價。」

Practice 37

> “The business performs competitively despite its size.”

「這間公司雖然規模小，但表現仍**很有競爭力**。」

competitively = 以足以與對手抗衡 / 爭勝的方式

19. **competitive advantage** = 競爭優勢

A high-value business compound.

Practice 38

> “Fresh bread gives the bakery a **competitive advantage**.”

「新鮮麵包為這間麵包店帶來**競爭優勢**。」

Practice 39

> “Customer loyalty can become a competitive advantage.”

「顧客忠誠度可以成為一項**競爭優勢**。」

competitive advantage = 令企業比競爭對手更有利、更容易吸引客戶或取得市場優勢的特點

20. **non-competitive** = 非競爭性的；缺乏競爭力的

A useful opposite.

Practice 40

> “The activity is **non-competitive**.”

「這項活動是**非競賽性 / 不強調競爭**的。」

Practice 41

> “The company became non-competitive because its costs were too high.”

「公司因成本過高而變得**缺乏競爭力**。」

non-competitive can mean:

1. not organised around winning/losing;
2. unable to compete effectively.

Context decides.

Important distinction: **competition vs contest**

competition

can mean:

- * ongoing rivalry
- * an organised competition

contest

usually specifically:

a particular organised event where people try to win.

> business competition

> = 商業競爭

> baking contest

> = 烘焙比賽

So **contest** cannot replace **competition** in your passage.

Important distinction: **competition vs rivalry**

competition

focuses on competing for the same goal/resource.

rivalry

focuses on an ongoing competitive relationship between particular rivals.

> competition among bakeries

> = 麵包店之間的競爭

> rivalry between two famous bakeries

> = 兩間著名麵包店長期的競爭關係

Important distinction: **competition vs battle**

You just curated **battle**.

competition

neutral:

people/businesses try to outperform one another.

battle

more intense/metaphorical:

suggests determined struggle.

> strong competition

> = 激烈競爭

> battle for customers

> = 爭奪客戶的大戰

Same situation, different intensity.

Important distinction: **competition vs conflict**

competition

does not necessarily involve hostility.

conflict

means direct disagreement, clash, or opposition.

Two businesses can compete intensely without being in conflict.

Important distinction: **competition vs cooperation**

competition

= trying to outperform or win limited resources.

cooperation

= working together toward a shared result.

They are conceptual opposites in many contexts, though both can coexist.

Important distinction: **competition vs competitor**

competition

= the process/situation.

competitor

= the person/business involved.

> “Competition is strong.”

= 競爭激烈。

> “Our main competitor is next door.”

= 我們主要競爭對手在隔壁。

Important distinction: **competition vs the competition**

This is highly testable.

competition

= rivalry/process

> “Competition is increasing.”

= 競爭正在加劇。

the competition

= rivals

> “We are cheaper than the competition.”

= 我們比競爭對手便宜。

Same noun, very different referent.

Important distinction: ****competitive — market vs person****

Market:

> “a competitive market”

= 競爭激烈的市場

Person:

> “a competitive person”

= 好勝的人

Business:

> “a competitive company”

can mean:

= 有競爭力的公司

Context determines the Chinese.

Excellent MCQ material.

Important distinction: ****competitive = fierce vs capable****

Two important senses:

****highly competitive market****

= 競爭非常激烈

****competitive business****

= 有能力與對手競爭

So ****competitive**** can describe either:

* the amount of competition present;

* the ability to succeed in competition.

Important distinction: **competitive price vs cheap price**

competitive price

= sufficiently attractive compared with rivals.

cheap

= low in absolute price.

A competitive price does not need to be the lowest.

Important distinction: **compete vs compare**

These are often confused.

compete

= try to win/outperform.

compare

= examine similarities/differences.

> “The bakeries compete with each other.”

= 麵包店彼此競爭。

> “Customers compare the bakeries.”

= 顧客比較這些麵包店。

Important distinction: **compete with vs compete for**

with/against

identifies the opponent:

> compete with another bakery

for

identifies the prize/resource:

> compete for customers

Very important grammar distinction.

Important distinction: **compete in** vs **compete for**

compete in

= take part in an event/field

> compete in a contest

compete for

= try to win a goal/prize

> compete for first prize

Important distinction: **healthy competition** vs **destructive competition**

healthy competition

= competition that motivates improvement without excessive harm.

destructive/cut-throat competition

= competition so intense that it may harm participants.

Useful business nuance, but these are collocational rather than separate senses.

Family-extension sweep

After the full audit, the useful modern family includes:

* **competition** — general rivalry = 競爭

* **competition** — business = 市場 / 商業競爭

* **competition** — contest = 比賽 / 競賽

* **competition** — competitive process = 競逐 / 較量

* **the competition** = 競爭對手 / 同行
 * **competition — pressure** = 競爭壓力
 * **competition — ecology** = 生態競爭
 * **compete** = 競爭 / 參賽
 * **compete with/against** = 與.....競爭
 * **compete for** = 爭奪 / 爭取
 * **compete in** = 參加比賽 / 在某領域競爭
 * **competitor** = 競爭者 / 競爭對手
 * **competitive — market** = 競爭激烈的
 * **competitive — person** = 好勝的
 * **competitive — business** = 有競爭力的
 * **competitive price** = 有競爭力的價格
 * **competitively priced** = 定價具競爭力
 * **competitively** = 具競爭力地
 * **competitive advantage** = 競爭優勢
 * **non-competitive** = 非競爭性的 / 缺乏競爭力的

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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competition — general	多個人 / 組織為取得同一目標、資源或優勢而互相較量
competition — business	同行企業為客戶、市佔率、收入或優勢而競爭的狀態
competition — contest	有正式規則、參賽者和結果的比賽 / 競賽
the competition	與自己爭奪同一市場、獎項或目標的對手
competition — pressure	因競爭者存在而產生的市場 / 表現壓力
competition — ecology	生物為有限的食物、空間、光、水等資源而互相爭奪
compete	為勝出、取得資源或優勢而與他人較量
compete with/against	與某個明確對手競爭
compete for	為取得某個目標、資源、名次或獎項而競爭
compete in	在某個比賽、運動、行業或市場中參與競爭
competitor	與自己競爭同一市場、目標或名次的人 / 企業
competitive — market	有很多參與者互相爭奪優勢，因此競爭激烈的
competitive — person	很想勝過別人、取得較好結果的；好勝的
competitive — business/product	具備足夠優勢，可與市場上的其他選項抗衡的
competitive price	與其他市場價格相比具有足夠吸引力的價格
competitive advantage	令企業比競爭對手更容易取得市場優勢的特點

For your original phrase

> “Of course, small businesses always face challenges such as rising rent and strong
 competition...”

The exact meaning is:

****competition = Golden Crust 要和附近其他麵包店、咖啡店、連鎖店等爭取相同顧客，因此面對持續而激烈的市場競爭。****

Natural translation:

> ****「當然，小生意永遠都會面對挑戰，例如租金上升和激烈競爭。」****

The highest-value contrasts are:

- > ****business competition**** → 商業 / 市場競爭
- > ****a baking competition**** → 烘焙比賽
- > ****the competition**** → 競爭對手 / 同行
- > ****competition for customers**** → 顧客爭奪
- > ****ecological competition**** → 生態競爭
- > ****competitor**** → 競爭對手
- > ****competitive market**** → 競爭激烈的市場
- > ****competitive person**** → 好勝的人
- > ****competitive business**** → 有競爭力的企業
- > ****competitive price**** → 有市場競爭力的價格